Officials believed the problems in Bangladesh needed all the strength, machinery and contacts that the Indian diplomats had. They also discussed certain pre-conditions for the new Bangladesh policy. A conscious decision was taken to give Bangladesh the highest priority in India's foreign policy because there was every possibility that it might become a big base of joint China-Pak operations, aided and abetted by the USA, which could cause chaos in the whole of eastern India within a few years. Giving Bangladesh higher priority meant the involvement of a greater number of people and also greater financial expenditure. Moreover, the Indian officials decided to take a hard look at the personnel handling the Bangladesh situation to learn whether they were capable of facing the new situation. Just experience and competence would not be enough, the officials believed. Diplomats in Bangladesh would also need proper motivation and understanding to be effective. If necessary, suitable non-govern-ment people could also be involved.

India had four major objectives for Bangladesh, the achievement of which would be aided by aggressive bureaucracy.

1) To prevent anti-Indian foreign powers using Bangladesh as abase of operations for anti-Indian activities in the political, economic and military spheres.

2) To prevent the development of a situation in Bangladesh which might compel the Hindu minority to migrate to India.

3) To have a friendly government in Dhaka.